

DAI-O KOKUSHI: ON ZEN

There is a reality even prior to heaven and earth;
Indeed, it has no form, much less a name;
Eyes fail to see it; it has no voice for ears to detect.
To call it Mind or Buddha violates its nature,
For it then becomes like a visionary flower in the air.

It is not Mind, nor Buddha;
Absolutely quiet and yet illuminating in a mysterious way,
It allows itself to be perceived only by the clear-eyed.
It is Dharma, truly beyond form and sound;
It is Tao, having nothing to do with words.

Wishing to entice the blind,
The Buddha has playfully let words escape his golden mouth;
Heaven and earth are ever since filled with entangling briars.
O my good worthy friends gathered here,
If you desire to listen to the thunderous voice of the Dharma,
Exhaust your words, empty your thoughts,
For then you may come to recognize this one essence.

SONG OF ENLIGHTENMENT

There is the leisurely one,
walking the Tao, beyond philosophy,
not avoiding fantasy, not seeking truth.
The real nature of ignorance is the Buddha-nature itself;
the empty delusory body is the very body of the Dharma.

When the Dharma body awakens completely,
there is nothing at all.
The source of our self-nature
is the Buddha of innocent truth.
Mental and physical reactions come and go
like clouds in the empty sky;
greed, hatred and ignorance appear and disappear
like bubbles on the surface of the sea.

When we realize actuality,
there is no distinction between mind and thing
and the path to hell instantly vanishes.
If this is a lie to fool the world,
my tongue may be cut out forever.

Once we awaken to the Tathagata-Zen,
the six noble deeds and the ten thousand good actions
are already complete within us.
In our dream we see the six levels of illusion clearly;
After we awaken the whole universe is empty.

No bad fortune, no good fortune, no loss, no gain;
never seek such things in eternal serenity.
For years the dusty mirror has gone uncleaned,
now let us polish it completely, once and for all.

Who has no-thought? Who is not-born?
If we are truly not-born, we are not un-born either.
Ask a robot if this is not so.
How can we realize ourselves
by virtuous deeds or by seeking the Buddha?

Release your hold on earth, water, fire, wind;
drink and eat as you wish in eternal serenity.
All things are transient and completely empty;
this is the great enlightenment of the Tathagata.

Transience, emptiness and enlightenment --
these are the ultimate truths of Buddhism;
keeping and teaching them is true Sangha devotion.
If you don't agree, please ask me about it.
Cut out directly the root of it all:
this is the very point of the Buddha-seal.
I can't respond to any concern about leaves and branches.

People do not recognize the Mani-jewel.
Living intimately within the Tathagata-garbha,
it operates our sight, hearing, smell, taste, sensation, awareness;
and all of these are empty, yet not empty.

The rays shining from this perfect Mani-jewel
have the form of no form at all.
Clarify the five eyes and develop the five powers;
this is not intellectual work -- just realize, just know.
It is not difficult to see images in a mirror,
but who can take hold of the moon in the water?

Always working alone, always walking alone,
the enlightened one walks the free way of Nirvana
with melody that is old and clear in spirit
and naturally elegant in style,
but with body that is tough and bony,
passing unnoticed in the world.

We know that Shakya's sons and daughters
are poor in body, but not in the Tao.
In their poverty, they always wear ragged clothing,
but they have the jewel of no price treasured within.

The jewel of no price can never be used up
though they spend it freely to help people they meet.
Dharmakaya, Sambhogakaya, Nirmanakaya,
and the four kinds of wisdom
are all contained within.
The eight kinds of emancipation and the six universal powers
are all impressed on the ground of their mind.

The best student goes directly to the ultimate;
the others are very learned but their faith is uncertain.
Remove the dirty garments from your own mind;
why should you show off your outward striving?

Some may slander, some may abuse;
they try to set fire to the heavens with a torch
and end by merely tiring themselves out.
I hear their scandal as though it were ambrosial truth;
immediately everything melts
and I enter the place beyond thought and words

When I consider the virtue of abusive words,
I find the scandal-monger is my good teacher.
If we do not become angry at gossip,
we have no need for powerful endurance and compassion.

To be mature in Zen is to be mature in expression,
and full-moon brilliance of dhyana and prajna
does not stagnate in emptiness.
Not only can I take hold of complete enlightenment by myself,
but all Buddha-bodies, like sands of the Ganges,
can become awakened in exactly the same way.

The incomparable lion-roar of the doctrine
shatters the brains of the one hundred kinds of animals.
Even the king of elephants will run away, forgetting his pride;
only the heavenly dragon listens calmly, with pure delight.

I wandered over rivers and seas, crossing mountains and streams,
visiting teachers, asking about the Way in personal interviews;
since I recognized the Sixth Founding Teacher at Ts'ao Ch'i,
I know what is beyond the relativity of birth and death.

Walking is Zen, sitting is Zen;
speaking or silent, active or quiet, the essence is at peace.
Even facing the sword of death, our mind is unmoved;
even drinking poison, our mind is quiet.

Our teacher, Shakyamuni, met Dipankara Buddha
and for many eons he trained as Kshanti, the ascetic.
Many births, many deaths;
I am serene in this cycle -- there is no end to it.

Since I abruptly realized the unborn,
I have had no reason for joy or sorrow
at any honor or disgrace.
I have entered the deep mountains to silence and beauty;
in a profound valley beneath high cliffs,
I sit under the old pine trees.
Zazen in my rustic cottage
is peaceful, lonely and truly comfortable.

When you truly awaken,
you have no formal merit.
In the multiplicity of the relative world,
you cannot find such freedom.
Self-centered merit brings the joy of heaven itself,
but is like shooting an arrow at the sky;
when the force is exhausted, it falls to the earth,
and then everything goes wrong.

Why should this be better
than the true way of the absolute,
directly penetrating the ground of Tathagata?
Just take hold of the source
and never mind the branches.
It is like a treasure-moon
enclosed in a beautiful emerald.
Now I understand this Mani-jewel
and my gain is the gain of everyone endlessly.

The moon shines on the river,
the wind blows through the pines.
Whose providence is this long beautiful evening?
The Buddha-nature jewel of morality
is impressed on the ground of my mind,
and my robe is the dew, the fog, the cloud and the mist.

A bowl once calmed dragons
and a staff separated fighting tigers;
the rings on this staff jingle musically.
The form of these expressions is not to be taken lightly;
the treasure-staff of the Tathagata
has left traces for us to follow.

The awakened one does not seek truth --
does not cut off delusion.
Truth and delusion are both vacant and without form,
but this no-form is neither empty nor not empty;
it is the truly real form of the Tathagata.

The mind-mirror is clear, so there are no obstacles.
Its brilliance illuminates the universe
to the depths and in every grain of sand.
Multitudinous things of the cosmos
are all reflected in the mind,
and this full clarity is beyond inner and outer.

To live in nothingness is to ignore cause and effect;
this chaos leads only to disaster.
The one who clings to vacancy, rejecting the world of things,
escapes from drowning but leaps into fire.

Holding truth and rejecting delusion --
these are but skillful lies.
Students who do zazen by such lies
love thievery in their own children.

They miss the Dharma-treasure;
they lose accumulated power;
and this disaster follows directly upon dualistic thinking.
So Zen is the complete realization of mind,
the complete cutting off of delusion,
the power of wise vision penetrating directly to the unborn.

Students of vigorous will hold the sword of wisdom;
the prajna edge is a diamond flame.
It not only cuts off useless knowledge,
but also exterminates delusions.

They roar with Dharma-thunder;
they strike the Dharma-drum;
they spread clouds of love, and pour ambrosial rain.
Their giant footsteps nourish limitless beings;
Shravaka, Pratyeka, Bodhisattva -- all are enlightened;
five kinds of human nature -- all are emancipated.

High in the Himalayas, only fei-ni grass grows.
Here cows produce pure and delicious milk,
and this food I continually enjoy.
One complete nature passes to all natures;
one universal Dharma encloses all Dharmas.

One moon is reflected in many waters;
all the water-moons are from the one moon.
The Dharma-body of all Buddhas has entered my own nature,
and my nature becomes one with the Tathagata.
One level completely contains all levels;
it is not matter, mind nor activity.
In an instant eighty-thousand teachings are fulfilled;
in a twinkling the evil of eons is destroyed.

All categories are no category;
what relation have these to my insight?
Beyond praise, beyond blame
like space itself it has no bounds.

Right here it is eternally full and serene,
if you search elsewhere, you cannot see it.
You cannot grasp it, you cannot reject it;
in the midst of not gaining,
in that condition you gain it.

It speaks in silence,
in speech you hear its silence.
The great way has opened and there are no obstacles.
If someone asks, "what is your sect
and how do you understand it?"
I reply, "the power of tremendous prajna."

People say it is positive;
people say it is negative;
but they do not know.
A smooth road, a rough road --
even heaven cannot imagine.
I have continued my zazen for many eons;
I do not say this to confuse you.

I raise the Dharma-banner and set forth our teaching;
it is the clear doctrine of the Buddha
which I found with my teacher, Hui Neng.
Mahakashyapa became the Buddha successor,
received the lamp and passed it on.
Twenty-eight generations of teachers in India,
then over seas and rivers to our land
Bodhidharma came as our own first founder,
and his robe, as we all know, passed through six teachers here.
And how many generations to come may gain the path,
no one knows.

The truth is not set forth;
the false is basically vacant.
Put both existence and non-existence aside;
then even non-vacancy is vacant.
The twenty kinds of vacancy have no basis,
and the oneness of the Tathagata-being
is naturally sameness.

Mind is the base, phenomena are dust;
yet both are like a flaw in the mirror.
When the flaw is brushed aside,
the light begins to shine.
When both mind and phenomena are forgotten,
then we become naturally genuine.

Ah, the degenerate materialistic world!
People are unhappy; they find self-control difficult.
In the centuries since Shakyamuni, false views are deep,
demons are strong, the Dharma is weak, disturbances are many.

People hear the Buddha's doctrine of immediacy,
and if they accept it, the demons will be crushed
as easily as a roofing tile.
But they cannot accept. What a pity!

Your mind is the source of action;
your body is the agent of calamity;
no pity nor blame to anyone else.
If you don't seek an invitation to hell,
never slander the Tathagata's true teaching.

In the sandalwood forest, there is no other tree.
Only the lion lives in such deep luxuriant woods,
wandering freely in a state of peace.
Other animals and birds stay far away.

Just baby lions follow the parent,
and three-year-olds already roar loudly.
How can the jackal pursue the king of the Dharma
even with a hundred-thousand demonic arts?

The Buddha's doctrine of directness
is not a matter for human emotion.
If you doubt this or feel uncertain,
then you must discuss it with me.
This not the free rein of a mountain monk's ego.
I fear your training may lead to wrong views
of permanent soul or complete extinction.

Being is not being; non-being is not non-being;
miss this rule by a hair,
and you are off by a thousand miles.
Understanding it, the dragon-child abruptly attains Buddhahood;
misunderstanding it, the greatest scholar falls into hell.

From my youth I piled studies upon studies,
in sutras and shastras I searched and researched,
classifying terms and forms, oblivious to fatigue.
I entered the sea to count the sands in vain
and then the Tathagata scolded me kindly
as I read "What profit in counting your neighbor's treasure?"
My work had been scattered and entirely useless,
for years I was dust blown by the wind.

If the seed-nature is wrong, misunderstandings arise,
and the Buddha's doctrine of immediacy cannot be attained.
Shravaka and Pratyeka students may study earnestly
but they lack aspiration.
Others may be very clever,
but they lack prajna.

Stupid ones, childish ones,
they suppose there is something in an empty fist.
They mistake the pointing finger for the moon.
They are idle dreamers lost in form and sensation.

Not supposing something is the Tathagata,
this is truly called Kuan-Yin, the Bodhisattva who sees freely.
When awakened we find karmic hindrances fundamentally empty
but when not awakened, we must repay all our debts.

The hungry are served a king's repast;
and they cannot eat.
The sick meet the king of doctors;
why don't they recover?
The practice of Zen in this greedy world --
this is the power of wise vision.
The lotus lives in the midst of the fire;
it is never destroyed.

Pradhanashura broke the gravest precepts;
but he went on to realize the unborn.
The Buddhahood he attained in that moment
lives with us now in our time.

The incomparable lion roar of the doctrine!
How sad that people are stubbornly ignorant,
just knowing that crime blocks enlightenment,
not seeing the secret of the Tathagata teaching.

Two monks were guilty of murder and carnality.
Their leader, Upali, had the light of a glow-worm;
he just added to their guilt.
Vimalakirti cleared their doubts at once
as sunshine melts the frost and snow.

The remarkable power of emancipation
works wonders innumerable as the sands of the Ganges.
To this we offer clothing, food, bedding, medicine.
Ten thousand pieces of gold are not sufficient;
though you break your body

and your bones become powder,
this is not enough for repayment.
One vivid word surpasses millions of years of practice.

The King of the Dharma deserves our highest respect.
Tathagatas, innumerable as sands of the Ganges,
all prove this fact by their attainment.
Now I know what the Mani-jewel is:
those who believe this will gain it accordingly.

When we see truly, there is nothing at all.
There is no person; there is no Buddha.
Innumerable things of the universe
are just bubbles on the sea.
Wise sages are all like flashes of lightning.

However the burning iron ring revolves about my head,
with bright completeness of dhyana and prajna,
I never lose my equanimity.
If the sun becomes cold, and the moon hot,
evil cannot shatter the truth.
The carriage of the elephant moves like a mountain,
how can the mantis block the road?

The great elephant does not loiter on the rabbit's path.
Great enlightenment is not concerned with details.
Don't belittle the sky by looking through a pipe.
If you still don't understand, I will settle it for you.

THE COINCIDENCE OF OPPOSITES

The mind of the great sage of India
was intimately conveyed from west to east.
Though people may be sharp-witted or dull,
there's no north and south in the Way.
The deep spring sparkles in the pure light,
its branches streaming through the darkness.
Grasping at phenomena is the source of delusion;
uniting with the absolute falls short of awakening.
All of the senses, all the things sensed,
they interact without interaction.
Interacting, they permeate one another,
yet each remains in its own place.
By nature, forms differ in shape and appearance.
By nature, sounds bring pleasure or pain.
In darkness, the fine and mediocre accord;
brightness makes clear and murky distinct.
Each element comes back to its own nature
just as a child finds its own mother.
Fire is hot, the wind blows, water is wet and earth solid,
eyes see forms, ears hear sounds, noses smell,
tongues tell salty from sour--so it is with everything everywhere.
The root puts forth each separate shoot.
Both root and shoot go back to the fundamental fact.
Exalted and lowly is just a matter of words.
In the very midst of light, there is darkness;
don't meet another in darkness.
In the very midst of darkness, there is light;
don't observe another in the light.
Light and darkness complement each other
like the foot before and the foot behind in walking.
Each of the myriad things has its particular virtue
inevitably expressed in its use and station.
Phenomena accord with the fundamental as a lid fits its box;
the fundamental meets phenomena like arrows in mid-air.
Hearing these words, understand the fundamental;
don't cook up principles from your own ideas.
If you overlook the Way right before your eyes,
how will you know the path beneath your feet?
Advancing has nothing to do with near and far,
yet delusion creates obstacles high and wide.
Students of the mystery, I humbly urge you,
don't waste a moment, night or day!

SONG OF THE GRASS-ROOF HERMITAGE

I built a grass hut where there's nothing of value.
After eating, I relax and enjoy a nap.
When it was completed, fresh weeds appeared.
Now it's been lived in -- covered by weeds.

The person in the hut lives here calmly,
not stuck to inside, outside, or in between.
Places worldly people live, s/he doesn't live.
Realms worldly people love, s/he doesn't love.
Though the hut is small, it includes the entire world.
In ten feet square, an old one illumines forms and their nature.
A Great Vehicle bodhisattva trusts without doubt.
The middling or lowly can't help wondering:
Will this hut perish or not?
Perishable or not, the original master is present,
not dwelling south or north, east or west.

Firmly based on steadiness, it can't be surpassed.
A shining window below the green pines --
jade palaces or vermilion towers can't compare with it.
Just sitting with head covered all things are at rest.
Thus, this mountain monk doesn't understand at all.
Living here s/he no longer works to get free.
Who would proudly arrange seats, trying to entice guests?

Turn around the light to shine within, then just return.
The vast inconceivable source can't be faced or turned away from.
Meet the ancestral teachers, be familiar with their instruction,
bind grasses to build a hut, and don't give up.
Let go of hundreds of years and relax completely.
Open your hands and walk, innocent.
Thousands of words, myriad interpretations,
are only to free you from obstructions.
If you want to know the undying person in the hut,
don't separate from this skin bag here and now.

VERSE OF THE FAITH-MIND

The supreme way is not difficult
if only you do not choose.
When there is neither love nor hate,
all is open and clear.
If there is the slightest distinction,
it is the distance between heaven and earth.
If you wish to see it revealed,
let go of preference and aversion.
The conflict between like and dislike
is a disease of the mind.
When this deep truth is not understood,
you try to still your thoughts in vain.

The way is perfect, like vast space,
with nothing lacking and nothing in excess.
It is only because you accept and reject
that its Suchness is lost.
Neither chase after outer appearances
nor stay in the awareness of the void:
simply be serene in the One
and confusion will disappear by itself.
When you stop activity to return to stillness,
the stopping itself is just more activity.
Remaining in duality,
how will you ever know the One?
Unless you penetrate the One,
you cannot function in either realm.
To reject existence is to lose existence;
to follow the void is to go against the void.

The more words and thoughts,
the less they fit the reality.
Cut off words, cut off thoughts,
and there is no place it does not penetrate.
Return to the root and you gain the truth,
follow appearances and you lose the essence.
Even an instant of interior illumination
goes beyond the first void;
changes in this relative void
are due entirely to delusion.

No need to search for the truth:
just let go of all your opinions,
not abiding in dualistic views,
careful not to pursue them.
For if there is a bit of right and wrong,
the mind is lost in confusion.

There are two because there is one,
but do not then cling to the one.
When the one mind does not arise,
the ten thousand things have no blame.
When there is no blame, there is no thing;
when it does not arise, there is no mind.
Subject vanishes along with object;
object vanishes along with subject.
Object is object because there is subject;
subject is subject because there is object.
If you want to know both levels --
they are originally one void.
The one void is the same in both
and they equally contain all things.
When you do not distinguish between fine and coarse,
how can there be any bias?

The Great Way is in essence broad,
neither easy nor difficult.
To hold narrow views causes apprehension;
the more you hurry, the longer it takes.
If you cling to such views,
the right measure is lost,
and you are sure to go astray.
Let go of them and everything is natural;
in essence there is neither going nor staying.
Just act according to your nature,
and you will accord with the Way,
walking it leisurely, free from care.

Discursive thought turns away from the truth;
a dull, murky mind won't do either.
Feeling dislike, the spirit is troubled;
what use is there in being for or against things?
If you want to take the one vehicle,
have no aversion to the world of the senses.

Indeed, not hating the sense world
is identical with true enlightenment.

The wise have no goals,
the ignorant shackle themselves:
for although among things there are no differences,
they vainly form attachments.
Using the mind to seek the mind --
isn't that a great mistake?
Rest and unrest arise in delusion,
enlightenment knows neither like nor dislike.
All dualistic views come
from your own mistaken deductions.

They are dreams, fantasies, spots before your eyes;
why do you try to grasp them?
Gain and loss, right and wrong --
let go of them once and for all!

If the eyes never sleep,
dreams naturally cease;
if the mind does not distinguish,
everything is One Suchness.
The essence of One Suchness is a mystery:
unmoving, absolute, karmic relations forgotten.
When you see all things equally,
they return to their natural state:
causation disappears and comparisons cannot be made.

Stop moving and there is no movement;
put rest in motion and there is no rest.
Since the two do not exist,
how can there be one?
In the absolute there are no rules;
the mind that accords with it becomes impartial,
ceasing to plan and strive.
When doubts and suspicion are cleared away,
true faith is easily attained.

All things are transitory;
there is no need to remember them.
Void, clear, self-illuminating --
the mind does not make efforts.

This is the place of no-thinking,
difficult to fathom with intellect or feeling.

In the dharma world of Suchness,
there is no other, there is no self.
When you are asked to express it immediately,
you can only say, "Not two!"
If not-two, then everything is the same;
there is nothing that is not included.
The wise of the ten directions
have all entered this truth;
it is beyond expansion and contraction;
one moment of awareness is ten thousand years.

Neither being nor non-being,
the entire universe is before your eyes.
The infinitely small is the same as the large;
boundaries have vanished.
The infinitely large is the same as the small;
divisions cannot be seen.
Being is nothing but non-being;
non-being is nothing but being.
When it is not yet like this for you,
by no means remain in that state.
One is all, all is one.
If you realize it thus,
why worry about not finishing?

The faith-mind is not-two;
not-two is the faith-mind.
Words fail to express it.
It is not of the past, future or present.

DISCOURSE ON LOVE

Those who want to attain peace should practice being upright, humble, and capable of using loving speech. They will know how to live simply and happily, with senses calmed, without being covetous and carried away by the emotions of the majority. Let them not do anything that will be disapproved of by the wise ones.

(And this is what they contemplate):

"May everyone be happy and safe, and may their hearts be filled with joy.

"May all living beings live in security and in peace: beings who are frail or strong, tall or short, big or small, visible or not visible, near or far away, already born or yet to be born. May all of them dwell in perfect tranquility.

"Let no one do harm to anyone. Let no one put the life of anyone in danger. Let no one, out of anger or ill will, wish anyone any harm.

"Just as parents love and protect their children at the risk of their own lives, we should cultivate boundless love to offer to all living beings in the entire cosmos. We should let our boundless love pervade the whole universe, above, below and across.

"Our love will know no obstacles, our heart will be absolutely free from hatred and enmity. Whether standing or walking, sitting or lying, as long as we are awake, we should maintain this mindfulness of love in our own hearts. This is the noblest way of living."

Free from wrong views, greed and sensual desires, living in beauty and realizing perfect understanding, those who practice boundless love will certainly transcend birth and death.

DISCOURSE ON HAPPINESS

I heard these words of the Buddha one time when the Lord was living in the vicinity of Shravasti at the Anathapindika monastery in the Jeta Park. Late at night a deva appeared whose light and beauty made the whole Jeta Grove shine radiantly. After paying respects to the Buddha, the deva asked him a question in the form of a verse:

“Many gods and men are eager to know
what are the greatest blessings
which can bring about a peaceful and happy life.
Please, Tathagata, will you teach us?”

(This is the Buddha’s answer):

“Not to be associated with the foolish ones,
to live in the company of wise people
and to honor those who are worth honoring –
this is the greatest happiness.

“To live in a good environment,
to have planted good seeds
and to realize that you are on the right path –
this is the greatest happiness.

“To have a chance to learn,
and to be skillful in your profession or craft
and to know how to practice the precepts and loving speech –
this is the greatest happiness.

“To be able to support your parents,
to cherish your own family
and to have a job that you like –
this is the greatest happiness.

“To live correctly, to be generous in giving,
to be able to give support to relatives and friends
and to live a life of blameless conduct –
this is the greatest happiness.

“To avoid doing bad things,
to avoid being caught by alcoholism or drugs
and to be diligent in doing good things –
this is the greatest happiness.

“To be humble and polite,
to be grateful and content with a simple life
and not to miss the occasion to learn the dharma –
this is the greatest happiness.

“To persevere and be open to change,
to have regular contact with monks and nuns
and to participate in dharma discussions –
this is the greatest happiness.

“To live diligently and attentively,
to perceive the Noble Truths
and to realize Nirvana –
this is the greatest happiness.

“To live in the world,
with your heart undisturbed by the world,
with all sorrows ended, dwelling in peace –
this is the greatest happiness.

“He or she who accomplishes this
will remain unvanquished wherever she goes.
Always he will be safe and happy –
this is the greatest happiness.”

SOURCES

Actualizing the Fundamental Point

Translation and copyright by Paul Jaffe, Flowers Fall: A Commentary on Dogen's Genjokoan, 1996.

Coincidence of Opposites, The

Attributed to Shih-T'ou Hsi-ch'ien [Shitou Xiqian], 700-790. Translation and copyright by Nelson Foster and Jack Shoemaker, The Roaring Stream: A New Zen Reader, 1996.

Discourse on Happiness

Mahamangala Sutta (Suttanipata 1) adapted by Thich Nhat Hanh for the Plum Village Chanting Book.

Discourse on Love

Metta Sutta (Suttanipata 1) adapted by Thich Nhat Hanh for the Plum Village Chanting Book.

Four Virtues of a Bodhisattva, The

Translation and copyright by Lew Richmond and Kazuaki Tanahashi, Moon in a Dewdrop, 1985. Adapted by Three Treasures Sangha, 2005.

Song of Enlightenment, The

Attributed to Yung-chia Hsüan-chüe [Yongjia Xuanjue], d. 713. Translation and revisions by Robert Aitken and copyright by the Honolulu Diamond Sangha, 1991.

Song of the Grass-Roof Hermitage

Attributed to Shih-T'ou Hsi-ch'ien [Shitou Xiqian], 700-790. Translation and copyright by Taigen Dan Leighton, Cultivating the Empty Field: The Silent Illumination of Zen Master Hongzhi, 1987)

Verse of the Faith-Mind

Attributed to Jianzhi Sengcan [Chien-Chih Seng-ts'an] d. 606.

Zazen Universally Recommended

Version by Robert Aitken, based on the translation by Carl Bielefeldt, Dōgen's Manuals of Zen Meditation, 1988.